

Malhotra Automobiles

UI/UX Design Specification

Customer website + product request + service booking + realtime chat + admin dashboard

Malhotra Automobiles — UI/UX Design Specification

Version: 1.0

Purpose: Visual and interaction specification for the customer website and admin dashboard.

Design principle: Premium, trustworthy, modern automotive commerce without looking like a generic template.

1. Design Vision

Malhotra Automobiles should feel like a **trusted local automobile expert that has a modern digital presence**.

The experience should communicate:

- Trust
- Professionalism
- Automotive expertise
- Convenience
- Reliability
- Local business character
- Clear, frictionless actions

Avoid:

- Overly flashy car-dealership aesthetics
- Excessive gradients
- Heavy glassmorphism
- Huge animations
- Generic SaaS dashboard styling
- Dark UI everywhere
- Cluttered ecommerce layouts

The interface should use **light surfaces, strong typography, automotive imagery, restrained dark sections, and a focused accent color**.

2. Brand Direction

Brand personality

Primary: Professional, reliable, knowledgeable

Secondary: Modern, approachable, efficient

Visual keywords

Automotive Premium Trustworthy Clean Technical Local

3. Color System

The initial palette should be based on a professional automotive identity and can later be adapted to the client's real logo/signage.

Core palette

Semantic colors

Use semantic colors sparingly. Status should be recognizable through **text + icon + color**, not color alone.

4. Typography

Use **Inter** or a similar highly readable modern sans-serif.

Type scale

- Display: 48–64px / 1.05
- H1: 40–48px / 1.1
- H2: 30–36px / 1.2
- H3: 22–26px / 1.25
- H4: 18–20px / 1.3
- Body large: 18px / 1.55
- Body: 15–16px / 1.5
- Small: 13–14px / 1.45
- Caption: 12px / 1.4

Desktop headings may scale down on tablets/mobile.

Typography rules:

- Use semibold/bold for important headings.
- Avoid excessive all-caps.
- Keep paragraphs short.
- Use tabular numerals where useful in dashboard tables.
- Prices should have strong visual hierarchy.

5. Spacing System

Use a 4px base spacing system:

4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64, 80, 96

Recommended:

- Card padding: 20–24px
- Section spacing: 64–96px desktop
- Mobile section spacing: 40–56px
- Form field gap: 16px
- Button height: 40–48px
- Mobile touch target: minimum 44px

6. Border Radius & Elevation

Use restrained rounded corners.

- Small controls: 6px

- Inputs/buttons: 8px
- Cards: 12px
- Large panels/modals: 16px
- Hero media: 16–20px

Shadows should be subtle.

Prefer:

- Border + very light shadow
- Clear separation between surfaces

Avoid floating everything.

7. Iconography

Use a consistent icon library such as Lucide.

Rules:

- 16px for compact controls
- 18–20px for buttons
- 24px for navigation/features
- 32px+ for feature illustrations

Icons should support labels rather than replace labels for important actions.

8. Layout Grid

Desktop

Maximum content width:

****1200–1280px****

Use:

- 12-column grid
- 24px gutters
- 24px side padding minimum

Tablet

- 8-column grid
- 20px gutters

Mobile

- 4-column conceptual grid
- 16px side padding
- 16px gutters

9. Customer Website Navigation

Desktop header:

****Logo | Home | Products | Services | About | Contact | Search | Cart | Book Service****

Primary CTA:

****Book a Service****

Mobile:

****Logo | Search | Cart | Menu****

The menu opens a full-height or large sheet navigation.

The cart count should remain visible.

10. Landing Page Layout

Section 1 — Hero

Two-column desktop layout.

Left:

- Eyebrow
- Strong headline
- Supporting copy
- Browse Products CTA
- Book a Service CTA

Right:

- High-quality automotive image

Suggested copy direction:

****Everything Your Vehicle Needs, Under One Roof.****

Supporting message should emphasize genuine products, professional service and local trust.

Mobile:

- Image first or image as background
- Headline
- Copy
- Stacked CTAs

Section 2 — Trust Strip

Four compact items:

- Genuine Products
- Expert Service
- Trusted Support
- Convenient Booking

Section 3 — Featured Products

- Section heading
- View all link
- 4-card desktop grid
- 2-card tablet
- Horizontal scroll or 2-column mobile

Section 4 — Services

Service cards with:

- Image
- Service name
- Short description
- Starting price if applicable
- Duration
- Book button

Section 5 — Why Choose Us

Use 3–4 strong reasons with icons.

Section 6 — Promotional Banner

Full-width dark automotive section.

Section 7 — Testimonials

Simple cards, not an oversized carousel.

Section 8 — Location / Contact

- Address
- Phone
- Opening hours
- Map
- Contact CTA

Section 9 — Footer

Columns:

- Business
- Products
- Services
- Support
- Contact
- Social links

11. Products Page

Desktop layout:

text

Breadcrumb

Products

Sidebar Filters | Search / Sort

Filters:

- Category

- Brand
- Price
- Availability
- Vehicle compatibility

Mobile:

- Search at top
- Filter button
- Sort button
- 2-column product grid

Product card:

- Image
- Wishlist icon (optional)
- Brand
- Product name
- Compatibility indicator
- Price
- Availability
- Add to Cart

Do not overload cards with technical specifications.

12. Product Details Page

Desktop:

Left:

- Image gallery

Right:

- Product title
- Brand
- SKU
- Price
- Availability
- Quantity
- Add to Cart
- Request/compatibility information

Below:

- Description
- Specifications
- Compatibility
- Related products

Mobile:

Image gallery first, then product information.

Primary Add to Cart action should remain easy to access.

13. Cart Page

Header:

****Your Cart****

Product list:

- Thumbnail
- Product
- Quantity
- Unit price
- Estimated line total
- Remove

Summary panel:

- Items
- Estimated total
- Continue shopping
- Proceed to Request

Prominent notice:

****Payment is completed at the business. This request reserves/collects the products you selected; it is not an online payment.****

14. Combined Request Flow

The system should support:

****Products only****

or

****Service only****

or

****Products + Service****

Recommended flow:

Step 1

Review products.

Step 2

Optional service selection.

Step 3

Select date.

Step 4

Select available time slot.

Step 5

Customer details.

Step 6

Review.

Step 7

Submit request.

Progress indicator:

Products → Service → Schedule → Details → Confirm

Allow skipping Service when unnecessary.

15. Service Booking Page

Use a clean step-based booking interface.

Desktop:

Left:

- Service selection

Center:

- Calendar

Right:

- Available time slots / summary

Mobile:

One step at a time.

Service cards should display:

- Image
- Name
- Duration
- Price
- Description

Calendar:

- Clear month navigation
- Available dates visually distinct
- Unavailable dates disabled
- Selected date highlighted

Time slots:

Use large selectable buttons.

Example:

09:00 AM 10:00 AM 11:00 AM

Selected slot should have strong accent styling.

16. Request Confirmation

Before submission show a clear summary:

Products

Product + quantity + estimated amount

Service

Service + date + time

Customer

Name + phone + email

Vehicle

Vehicle information

Important notice

Final product/service pricing and fulfilment are confirmed by Malhotra Automobiles.

Primary CTA:

****Submit Request****

After submission:

Success screen:

****Request Submitted****

Request ID:

MA-2026-00152

Status:

****Awaiting Confirmation****

Include:

- View Request
- Continue Shopping
- Contact Business

17. Request Status Page

Use a vertical timeline:

Submitted → Under Review → Accepted → Ready for Visit → Completed

Rejected/cancelled states should branch visually.

Show:

- Request number
- Current status
- Products
- Service
- Booking time
- Customer details
- Business contact

18. Chat UX

Persistent floating chat button on customer pages.

Default:

****Chat with us****

Opening the widget:

Header:

****Malhotra Automobiles****

Status:

****Usually replies quickly****

AI conversation should clearly identify itself when appropriate.

Example:

> Hi! I'm the Malhotra Automobiles assistant. How can I help?

Quick actions:

- Find a product
- Book a service
- Ask about services
- Contact the business

Human handoff:

****Talk to Malhotra Automobiles****

Human messages should be visually distinct from AI messages.

Mobile chat should become a full-screen panel.

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19. Customer Account

If accounts are enabled:

Dashboard sections:

- Overview
- My Requests
- My Bookings
- My Vehicles
- Messages
- Profile

Keep customer dashboard much simpler than admin dashboard.

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20. Admin Dashboard Design

The admin UI should prioritize **information density and speed**.

Layout:

text

[illegible]

■ Sidebar ■ Header ■

[REDACTED]

■ Dashboard ■ ■

■ Products ■ Main Content ■

■ Services ■ ■

■ Bookings ■ ■

■ Requests ■ ■

■ Customers ■ ■

■ Chat ■ ■

■ Notifications ■ ■

■ Settings ■ ■

[REDACTED]

Desktop sidebar:

- Fixed width ~240px

- Collapsible to icon rail

Mobile:

- Top header
- Sheet/drawer navigation

21. Admin Dashboard Home

Top metric cards:

- Pending Requests
- Today's Bookings
- Upcoming Bookings
- Unread Chats

Below:

Today's Bookings

Compact table/list.

Pending Requests

Priority queue.

Recent Activity

Timeline.

Quick Actions

- Add Product
- Add Service
- Create Slots
- View Requests

22. Admin Product Management

Use a data table.

Columns:

- Product
- Category
- Brand
- Price
- Availability
- Published
- Updated
- Actions

Top actions:

- Add Product
- Search
- Filter
- Bulk publish/unpublish

Product editor should use grouped sections:

Basic Information

Pricing

Images

Specifications

Compatibility

Publishing

Use autosave only where safe; explicit Save is preferred for product editing.

23. Admin Service Management

Table/cards:

- Service
- Duration
- Price
- Status
- Updated
- Actions

Service editor mirrors product editor but remains simpler.

24. Availability Management

Use a calendar-first interface.

Controls:

- Date range
- Working hours
- Slot duration
- Capacity
- Block date
- Create slots

Allow recurring patterns such as:

****Monday–Saturday, 9 AM–6 PM, 1-hour slots****

Then allow individual overrides.

25. Admin Booking Calendar

Calendar views:

- Day
- Week
- Month

Booking card:

- Customer
- Vehicle
- Service

- Time
- Status

Click opens booking drawer/modal with full details.

Actions:

- Accept
- Reject
- Reschedule
- Cancel
- Mark completed
- Contact customer

26. Admin Request Management

Requests should be optimized as an operational queue.

Filters:

- Status
- Date
- Service
- Product
- Customer

Request detail panel:

- Customer
- Vehicle
- Products
- Service
- Slot
- Notes
- Timeline
- Communication

Primary actions should change depending on status.

27. Admin Chat

Three-panel desktop layout:

text

Conversations | Messages | Customer Context

Left:

- Conversation list
- Unread indicator
- Search

Center:

- Messages
- Composer

- AI/human state

Right:

- Customer
- Vehicle
- Requests
- Booking history

Mobile collapses into sequential screens.

28. Admin Notifications

Use notification center for:

- New requests
- Booking changes
- New chats
- System warnings

Unread count should be visible in sidebar/header.

29. Forms

All forms should:

- Have visible labels
- Use clear validation
- Explain errors next to fields
- Preserve user input on validation errors
- Disable submit during processing
- Provide success feedback

Example:

Phone number

Please enter a valid 10-digit phone number.

Never rely only on placeholder text as labels.

30. Loading / Empty / Error States

Every asynchronous area needs explicit states.

Loading

Use skeletons.

Empty

Explain what happened and provide an action.

Example:

****No bookings yet****

Book a Service

Error

Explain the problem in human language.

Example:

****We couldn't load available slots.****

Try Again

Avoid exposing raw server errors.

31. Toasts & Feedback

Use toast notifications for lightweight actions:

- Product added to cart
- Request submitted
- Product updated
- Booking accepted

Use inline confirmation for important actions.

Use modal confirmation for destructive actions.

32. Responsive Behavior

Desktop $\geq 1200\text{px}$

- Full navigation
- Multi-column grids
- Admin sidebar
- Large product grids
- Calendar + booking details side-by-side

Tablet 768–1199px

- Compact navigation
- Reduced grid columns
- Collapsible filters
- Admin sidebar can collapse

Mobile $< 768\text{px}$

- Hamburger navigation
- 2-column product grid
- Stacked booking steps
- Full-screen chat
- Bottom/sticky primary actions when useful
- Tables convert to cards/lists
- Avoid horizontal scrolling except intentional carousels

33. Accessibility

Target WCAG 2.2 AA where practical.

Requirements:

- Keyboard navigation

- Visible focus states
- Semantic HTML
- Accessible labels
- Sufficient contrast
- Alt text
- Screen-reader-friendly status updates
- Touch targets $\geq 44\text{px}$
- Reduced-motion support

Do not communicate status using color alone.

34. Animation System

Animations should feel **premium and restrained**.

Micro-interactions

- Button hover: 120–180ms
- Card hover: 150–220ms
- Modal: 180–240ms
- Dropdown: 120–180ms
- Page transition: 200–300ms

Use subtle:

- Opacity
- Transform
- Scale
- Height

Avoid:

- Excessive bouncing
- Large parallax
- Continuous motion
- Slow page transitions

Product interactions

On Add to Cart:

1. Button changes state briefly.
2. Cart count updates.
3. Small confirmation toast appears.

Booking

Selected date/slot should transition smoothly without distracting animation.

Respect:

``prefers-reduced-motion``.

35. Component Hierarchy

Shared components

text

App

■■■■ Header

■■■■ Footer

■■■■ ChatWidget

■■■■ Breadcrumbs

■■■■ SearchBar

■■■■ Button

■■■■ Input

■■■■ Select

■■■■ Modal

■■■■ Drawer

■■■■ Toast

■■■■ Badge

■■■■ Pagination

■■■■ LoadingSkeleton

Ecommerce components

text

ProductCard

ProductGrid

ProductGallery

ProductFilters

ProductDetails

QuantitySelector

CartItem

CartSummary

Booking components

text

ServiceCard

ServiceSelector

BookingStepper

Calendar

TimeSlotGrid

BookingSummary

BookingStatus

Admin components

text

AdminLayout

Sidebar
AdminHeader
MetricCard
DataTable
FilterBar
StatusBadge
RequestDrawer
BookingCalendar
ChatPanel
CustomerPanel

36. Customer Flow

Product request

text

Landing

↓

Products

↓

Product Details

↓

Add to Cart

↓

Cart

↓

Customer Details

↓

Review

↓

Submit

↓

Confirmation

↓

Owner Notification

Service booking

text

Landing

↓

Services

↓

Service Details

↓
Book Service
↓
Select Date
↓
Select Slot
↓
Customer Details
↓
Review
↓
Submit
↓
Confirmation

Combined request

text
Products
↓
Cart
↓
Add Service
↓
Select Date/Slot
↓
Customer Details
↓
Review Everything
↓
Submit

37. Admin Flow

Product

text
Dashboard
↓
Products
↓
Add Product
↓
Enter Details

↓

Upload Images

↓

Publish

↓

Visible on Website

Booking

text

Dashboard

↓

Bookings

↓

Review

↓

Accept / Reject

↓

Customer Notification

↓

Complete after visit

Chat

text

Customer message

↓

Realtime notification

↓

Admin Chat

↓

Reply

↓

Customer receives instantly

38. Mobile-Specific UX

Important actions should remain reachable.

Recommended mobile bottom actions where appropriate:

- Add to Cart
- Book Service
- Submit Request

Do not permanently occupy the screen with multiple floating controls.

Chat should be a single floating button.

Cart should show item count.

39. Content Design

Use concise, human language.

Prefer:

****Book your service****

instead of:

****Proceed to service appointment scheduling module****

Prefer:

****Request Submitted****

instead of:

****Transaction successfully processed****

The website should sound like a professional local business, not an enterprise software system.

40. SEO/UI Content Requirements

Every public page should have:

- Clear H1
- Useful page title
- Descriptive meta description
- Breadcrumbs where useful
- Descriptive image alt text
- Clean URLs

Product and service pages should expose meaningful content rather than only UI elements.

41. Design Tokens for Implementation

Define reusable CSS/Tailwind tokens rather than hard-coding values throughout components.

Recommended groups:

text

colors/

typography/

spacing/

radius/

shadows/

breakpoints/

motion/

z-index/

All components should consume tokens.

42. Design Principles for Claude Code

1. Do not generate a generic template.
2. Keep customer and admin visual languages related but distinct.

3. Prioritize mobile usability.
4. Build reusable components.
5. Avoid unnecessary dependencies.
6. Do not over-animate.
7. Do not invent business information.
8. Use realistic placeholder content only where real content is unavailable.
9. Preserve accessibility.
10. Build states, not just happy-path screens.
11. Every async operation needs loading/error/success handling.
12. Every important action needs clear feedback.
13. Keep the primary CTA visually obvious.
14. Avoid UI clutter.
15. Maintain consistent spacing, typography and component behavior.

43. Recommended Implementation Order

Phase 1 — Design Foundation

- Tokens
- Typography
- Colors
- Buttons
- Inputs
- Cards
- Navigation
- Layout primitives

Phase 2 — Public Website

- Home
- Products
- Product details
- Services
- Service details
- Cart

Phase 3 — Booking

- Booking stepper
- Calendar
- Time slots
- Customer details
- Confirmation
- Status

Phase 4 — Admin

- Admin shell
- Dashboard

- Products
- Services
- Availability
- Requests
- Bookings

Phase 5 — Communication

- Realtime chat
- Admin chat
- Notifications
- Email UI states

Phase 6 — AI

- Gemini assistant
- Business-data retrieval
- Human escalation

Phase 7 — Polish

- Accessibility
- Responsive refinement
- Loading/error states
- Animation
- SEO
- Performance
- E2E testing

44. Definition of Done — UI/UX

The design implementation is considered complete when:

- All public pages have desktop/tablet/mobile layouts.
- Admin dashboard works across desktop and tablet, with usable mobile fallback.
- Design tokens are centralized.
- Components are reusable.
- Product cards and forms are consistent.
- Booking flow is understandable without instructions.
- Cart/request distinction is clear.
- Status states are visually obvious.
- Chat is discoverable but not intrusive.
- Loading/empty/error states exist.
- Keyboard navigation works.
- Reduced-motion behavior works.
- No important information depends solely on color.
- Primary actions are clear.
- The experience feels like one coherent Malhotra Automobiles product.

45. Final Design Direction

The final product should feel like:

****A premium local automobile business brought online — not an online store pretending to be an automobile business.****

The strongest visual balance is:

****Automotive imagery + clean white surfaces + deep navy structure + restrained blue accent + strong typography + excellent spacing + fast interactions.****

The PRD defines what the system does.

This document defines how that system should look and behave.